

Daily Bible Note

Date: May 21, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 6:12—20

12 "All things are lawful for me, but all things are not helpful. All things are lawful for me, but I will not be brought under the power of any."

13 "Foods for the stomach and the stomach for foods, but God will destroy both it and them. Now the body is not for sexual immorality but for the Lord, and the Lord for the body."

14 "And God both raised up the Lord and will also raise us up by His power."

15 "Do you not know that your bodies are members of Christ? Shall I then take the members of Christ and make them members of a harlot? Certainly not!"

16 "Or do you not know that he who is joined to a harlot is one body with her? For 'the two,' He says, 'shall become one flesh.'"

17 "But he who is joined to the Lord is one spirit with Him."

18 "Flee sexual immorality. Every sin that a man does is outside the body, but he who commits sexual immorality sins against his own body."

19 "Or do you not know that your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you, whom you have from God, and you are not your own?"

20 "For you were bought at a price; therefore glorify God in your body and in your spirit, which are God's."

II. Key Summary

- "All things are lawful" was a Corinthian slogan — but Paul's reply cuts deeper: "I will not be brought under the power of any." The real test of freedom isn't what you can do, it's what controls you.
- The body matters to God. Paul says the body is "for the Lord" and God will raise it up — what you do with your body is never a small thing.

- "Your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit... you were bought at a price." This isn't a restriction — it's a statement about how much you're worth.
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III. Passage Analysis

Freedom, or Control?

"The power ought to be in the hands of the believer, not in the things which he uses." [1]

"All things are lawful for me" — Paul's own phrase, now being misused. He counters it with a wordplay in Greek: *I have power*, but *I will not be brought under the power of anything*. Real freedom isn't the ability to do whatever you want. It's the ability to stop. If something has a grip on you that you can't break, that's not freedom — even if it started as a choice. [1]

You Were Bought at a Price

"Any honest person will take better care of something that doesn't belong to them. Our bodies belong to God because He bought them." [2]

Verses 19–20 build an argument: your body is the Holy Spirit's temple → you are not your own → therefore glorify God in your body. The foundation is identity, not obligation. You weren't told to be pure because God is strict — you were told because you're worth something. You were bought at a high price, and what belongs to God has a dignity that can't just be thrown away. [2]

IV. Reflection Question

Is there something in your life you know isn't good for you, but you keep going back to anyway? If the fact that you can't stop is exactly what "being controlled" looks like — does that feel like freedom to you?

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Bengel's Gnomon, https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/6-12.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik Commentary, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-6/>